

KCL SCORES BIG, BOTH ON AND OFF THE FIELD



Kochi Blue Tigers players celebrating with the trophy after winning the KCL Season 2 final match at Greenfield International cricket stadium in Thiruvananthapuram

After an impactful entry into the cricketing ecosystem in the State, Kerala's own cricket carnival, the Kerala Cricket League (KCL) in its second season left a lasting impression on the fans with a grandeur show both on and off the field.

The Kerala Cricket Association's novelty-driven multifaceted approach raised the brand value of the league, making it one of the popular domestic cricket leagues in the country.

The second season kicked off with the grand unveiling of KCL's official mascots Veeru, the elephant; Charu, the great Indian hornbill; and Chakiyar the third umpire.

The month-long canter Van Trophy tour which traversed all the six districts from where the franchisees were based, spreading KCA's anti-drug message among school and college



Sanju Samson on his way to an scintillating century against Finesse Thrissur Titans



students. The vibrant fan village at Greenfield stadium with interactive fun games were designed to create a festival-like atmosphere for spectators.

The launch of the fan engagement app increased the popularity of the league on social media. The footfalls at the venue were

sufficiently higher compared to the last season.

Star attraction

On the field the biggest attraction was Sanju Samson, who was making his KCL debut for Kochi Blue Tigers. The Blue Tigers splurged more than half of their total purse to buy Sanju in the player auction. It was a gamble which Kochi dared to take, knowing pretty well that the player would not be available for the entire duration of the tournament.

Sanju played only six matches but left his indelible mark on the tournament. He scored a century, showcasing his silken elegance and poise, and three half centuries that lit up the night sky. Fans thronged the stadium to watch him bat and Sanju did not disappoint them.

Dominant Kochi

Led astutely by Saly Samson, Kochi Blue Tigers dominated the